



FEVICOL — FROM PROFESSIONAL TRUST TO CONSUMER CONFIDENCE

FEVICOL

Independent
Business Case Study
Umi Salma

SCOPE

Product strategy
Customer
analysis

LENS

Market research
Channel strategy

THE STRATEGIC QUESTION

Can Fevicol expand consumer DIY adoption without weakening the professional carpenter ecosystem that underpins its category leadership?

FEVICOL: BUILT ON PROFESSIONAL TRUST

From a 1959 wood working solution to a household adhesive brand—understanding the foundation behind Fevicol's next growth opportunity.

Fevicol is a flagship adhesive brand of Pidilite Industries Limited.

Introduced in 1959, it was created with a clear professional purpose: to make the work of carpenters and woodworkers easier.

The original Fevicol was developed as a white synthetic resin adhesive — a cleaner, more convenient alternative to the traditional animal-fat-based glue used in woodworking.



THE JOURNEY · FROM PROFESSIONAL TRUST TO CONSUMER REACH

1959

FEVICOL LAUNCH

Professional
woodworking solution

1960S

PROFESSIONAL TRUST

Carpenter-focused
demonstrations,
sampling and
relationship building

1970

CONSUMER EXPANSION

30g consumer pack
introduced

TODAY

MULTI- SEGMENT BRAND

Professional +
household + craft +
specialised applications

THE STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Fevicol's competitive strength is not only its adhesive product. It is the trust and familiarity built around solving real user problems.

STRATEGIC INTERPRETATION

Fevicol did not begin as a consumer DIY brand. It first built trust within the professional ecosystem and subsequently expanded into households and consumer use cases.

Pidilite Industries Limited

Fevicol is a flagship brand within a diversified company built around practical problem-solving.

CORPORATE STRUCTURE

From listed parent to flagship brand

PIDILITE INDUSTRIES LIMITED Listed parent company
FEVICOL COMPANY LTD. Wholly owned subsidiary
FEVICOL Flagship adhesive brand

FOUNDED BY

Shri Balvantray Kalyanji Parekh

Founder Chairman · 1924–2013

Pidilite identifies Balvantray Kalyanji Parekh as its Founder Chairman. His business philosophy centred on identifying practical problems and developing products that made everyday work easier.

Company context, not a market- performance claim.

PIDILITE'S BRAND ECOSYSTEM

A portfolio spanning professional and consumer needs

Category	Selected brands / solutions
Adhesives & bonding	Fevicol, Fevikwik, Araldite
Construction & waterproofing	Dr. Fixit, Roff
Repair & maintenance	M-Seal
Industrial solutions	Specialty adhesive & chemical solutions
Consumer / creative use	Art, stationery & craft applications

STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY · INTERPRETATION

Fevicol's strength comes from operating within a larger Pidilite ecosystem — combining brand equity, product expertise, distribution capabilities and access to multiple consumer and professional segments.

Pidilite is a promoter-led, predominantly consumer-facing business

The Fevicol opportunity sits inside a scaled consumer ecosystem — not a shift from B2B to B2C.

MARKET CAP ~US\$16.7B Pidilite listed equity market value	EQUITY VALUE ~₹1.51T Pidilite listed equity	REVENUE ~₹15,399 Cr Latest reported revenue	CONSUMER & BAZAAR 81.6% Share of reported business
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Market capitalisation represents the market value of Pidilite’s listed equity; it is not accounting net worth.

OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE — PIDILITE INDUSTRIES

Shareholder group	Ownership	Description
Promoters	69.24%	Majority ownership and strategic control
Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs)	11.69%	Global funds, foreign portfolio investors and international institutions
Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs)	9.88%	Mutual funds, insurers and domestic financial institutions
Retail, Public & Others	~9.18%	Individual investors and other non-institutional shareholders

THE BUSINESS MODEL

Pidilite operates across B2C and B2B markets

CONSUMER & BAZAAR — 81.6% Branded adhesives, construction chemicals, art & craft, household and other consumer-facing solutions.	B2B — 18.0% Industrial adhesives, resins, pigments, construction solutions and other industrial applications.
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OTHER — 0.4%
Other reported business activities.

June 2026 shareholding structure; ownership date note retained for the official filing.

WHY THIS MATTERS TO THE FEVICOL CASE · INTERPRETATION

Pidilite is already predominantly consumer-facing.

The strategic opportunity is not to transform the company from B2B to B2C — but to determine how Fevicol can deepen consumer engagement without weakening its professional ecosystem.

Professional Trust + Consumer Reach + Pidilite’s Distribution & Brand Ecosystem → Potential DIY Growth

FEVICOL'S GROWTH DILEMMA

THE PROBLEM

Can Fevicol expand into DIY to unlock genuinely new consumer demand—without cannibalising existing professional-led business?

Fevicol has built a strong, trusted professional ecosystem around carpenters and contractors. The brand also has a consumer presence: Pidilite introduced a 30g consumer pack in 1970 while maintaining its connection with the woodworking community. Source: Pidilite, Fevicol consumer brands.



THE STRATEGIC CHOICE

01 — PROTECT THE CORE

Continue prioritising the established carpenter-led ecosystem.

02 — EXPAND INTO DIY

Introduce a guided DIY proposition to capture additional consumer use cases.

THE KEY BUSINESS QUESTION

Will DIY create incremental growth—or simply shift existing professional demand to consumers?

Decision required: determine whether a DIY proposition can expand the market while protecting professional relationships, channel economics and long-term brand equity.

The DIY opportunity comes with a strategic trade-off

Fevicol can unlock additional consumer demand—but only if DIY strengthens, rather than substitutes for, professional expertise.

01 — CANNIBALISATION

New demand or shifted demand?

DIY could shift some small repair jobs from carpenters to consumers.

Question: Is DIY creating new demand—or replacing existing professional demand?

02 — CARPENTER ECOSYSTEM

Protect the influence network

Carpenters are more than end users; they are part of Fevicol's professional influence and usage ecosystem.

Risk: A poorly positioned DIY product could create channel conflict.

03 — PRICING

Different value, no friction

DIY customers pay for convenience, guidance and simplicity; professionals value performance, quantity and productivity.

Challenge: Create differentiated pricing without creating channel friction.

04 — PRODUCT COMPLEXITY

Turn expertise into guidance

Professionals know which adhesive to use and how to apply it. A first-time DIY user may not.

Opportunity: Make Fevicol's technical expertise simple and actionable.

KEY STRATEGIC QUESTION

How can Fevicol grow consumer DIY adoption without making DIY a substitute for professional expertise?

RESOLUTION

DIY + Carpenter within one ecosystem.

From Business Question to Investment Decision

To determine whether Fevicol should enter DIY, we evaluate market attractiveness, customer need, strategic fit and commercial viability.

Understand the Core Map brand strength, professional ecosystem, consumer portfolio and business model.	Size the Opportunity Assess simple, low-complexity DIY jobs where professional assistance may be unnecessary.	Identify the Right Customer Segment by need, job complexity, confidence and frequency of use.
Test the Strategic Fit Evaluate competitors, pricing, channels and overlap with carpenter-led demand.	Design the Proposition Build a guided, use-case-led offer across product, quantity, instructions, price and distribution.	Test the Economics Validate incremental revenue and customers, unit economics and cannibalisation risk.
Define the Decision Gates Measure adoption, repeat purchase, incremental customers, cannibalisation, contribution and professional sentiment.		

Strategic Principle

Add consumer-led demand without destroying existing value. The objective is not to replace the professional ecosystem, but to identify where DIY can expand the category safely.

Final Decision Gate

GO — scale the proposition | **MODIFY** — refine and retest | **NO-GO** — protect the core

Consistent with Pidilite’s Consumer & Bazaar and B2B segmentation, and its consumer portfolio’s focus on convenient, fuss-free solutions for everyday tasks. Source: Pidilite Annual Report 2024–25.

FEVICOL DIY+

Turning Professional Trust into Guided Consumer Confidence

Conceptual proposition — developed for this case study



THE PROPOSITION

Right product + right quantity + right guidance + right use case

Use-case adhesive · right-sized quantity · simple steps · job-complexity guidance · professional escalation.
Consumer confidence: know what to use, how much, how to apply, and when to ask for help.



DIGITAL GUIDANCE LAYER

Identify the job → Select the surface → Choose the product → Follow the guide → Complete the fix

A QR-enabled package could guide application and clearly flag when professional assistance is recommended.
Observable proof: a consumer reaches the right product and completes a simple fix.



WHY THIS FITS FEVICOL

Pidilite already serves homes, crafts, repairs and DIY through consumer-facing propositions including Fevicol MR and Fevikwik.
Source: pidilite.com consumer brand materials.

Strategic opportunity: extend existing consumer trust into a structured, use-case-led DIY proposition—not an entirely new category.



THE GUARDRAIL

Make simple jobs easier for consumers—while keeping complex jobs within the professional ecosystem.

The opportunity is not to replace carpenters with DIY. It is to support selected, low-complexity jobs and create a clear pathway to professional help when expertise is required.

Important: Fevicol DIY+ is a conceptual product architecture created for this case study, not an existing Fevicol product.

THE STRATEGY IS COMPLEMENTARITY, NOT REPLACEMENT

The proposed DIY model should expand Fevicol’s consumer reach while protecting the value of its established professional ecosystem.

A CLEAR ROLE FOR EACH SEGMENT

Use case	Recommended route	Strategic role
Minor household repairs	DIY	Capture new consumer occasions
Small furniture fixes	DIY	Build consumer confidence
Simple assembly / craft	DIY	Encourage product trial
Moderate or uncertain jobs	DIY → Professional	Enable escalation
Custom furniture	Carpenter	Preserve professional demand
Complex woodworking	Carpenter / Contractor	Protect expertise-led business

THE ECOSYSTEM MODEL



KEY PRINCIPLE
The boundary is not “Consumer vs. Carpenter.” The boundary is “**Simple Job vs. Complex Job.**”

Conceptual strategic model developed for this case study. DIY should become an entry point into the Fevicol ecosystem—not a substitute for professional expertise.

What Jobs Could a DIY Proposition Solve?

Start where the product role is easy to demonstrate and success can be seen quickly.

FURNITURE AND WOOD REPAIR

Visible need

Strong brand fit, with potentially higher guidance requirements around surface, amount, and application.

HOUSEHOLD REPAIR

Practical and episodic

A high “right product” question creates a clear role for selection guidance.

HOME DÉCOR

Project-led discovery

Visual outcomes can make the product’s use easier to understand.

CRAFT AND STUDENT PROJECTS

Accessible entry points

Instruction-heavy occasions where quantity and step order matter.

HOBBY PROJECTS

Potential repeat use

Repeat potential depends on clearer use-case communication and convenient formats.

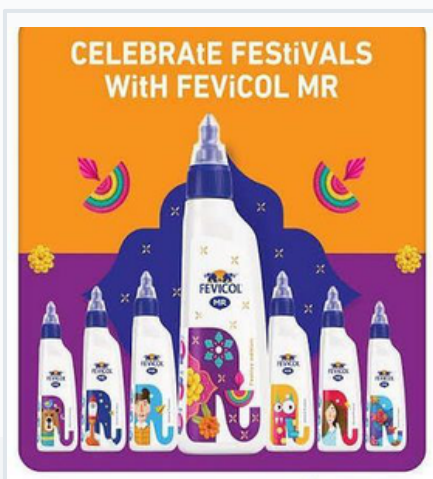
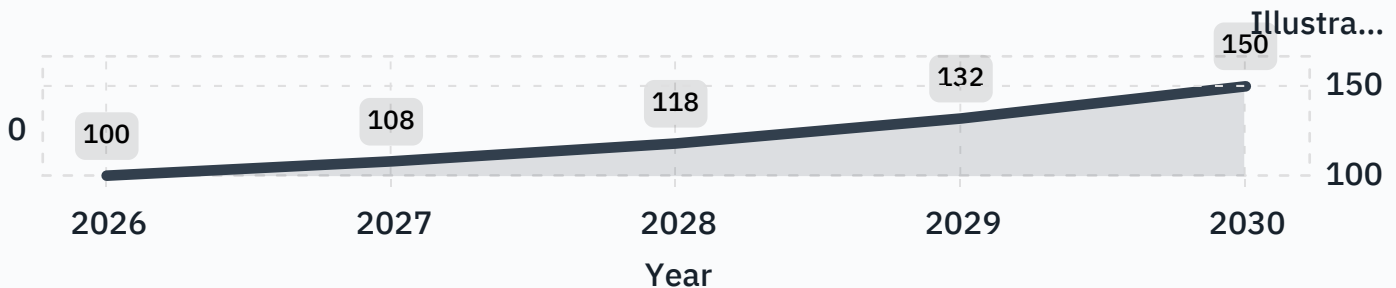
PRIORITY HYPOTHESIS

Begin with small home repairs and simple wood or craft jobs where the role is easy to demonstrate.

Priority reflects the case-study framework and available evidence, not measured market demand.

FROM DIY PILOT TO LONG-TERM GROWTH

Conceptual outcome of the proposed DIY+ strategy



EXPECTED OUTCOMES

↑ CUSTOMER BASE

Reach new consumer use cases and increase trial.

↑ CONSUMER OCCASIONS

Make Fevicol relevant for more everyday repair and DIY needs.

↑ BRAND STRENGTH

Extend existing trust into guided consumer usage.

↑ REGIONAL REACH

Build on Fevicol's established Indian leadership and international footprint.

LONG-TERM AMBITION

From India's trusted adhesive brand to a stronger consumer DIY platform across South Asia.

Potential strategic position: More customers → More use cases → More consumption → Stronger brand leadership

All growth figures shown are illustrative, not company forecasts or actual results. Context: Fevicol is reported at 70%+ market share in its relevant adhesive category; Pidilite public company materials describe Fevicol as a leading/trusted adhesive brand in India.

MODIFY → PILOT → SCALE

Expand Fevicol into DIY selectively—while protecting the professional ecosystem for complex work.

01 MODIFY

Develop a guided, use-case-led DIY+ proposition — not a generic DIY kit.

02 PILOT

Test selected use cases, pricing, and channels in a controlled market.

03 SCALE

Expand only after proving adoption, incremental demand, and sustainable economics.

STRATEGIC OUTCOME

New consumers → More DIY use cases → Higher product adoption → Stronger consumer franchise → **Professional ecosystem protected**

FINAL INSIGHT

The next growth opportunity is not replacing professional expertise — it is making Fevicol's existing trust accessible to a new generation of consumers.

DECISION

Independent business strategy & product strategy case study — conceptual analysis, not a Pidilite/Fevicol client engagement.